

AP Exam Selection Guide

Choose the right AP exams for your major — with credit transfer info for top US universities

■ Best AP Exams by Intended Major

Intended Major	Recommended AP Exams	Why
Engineering / CS	Calc BC, Physics C, CS A, Statistics	Core STEM requirements covered
Pre-Med / Biology	Biology, Chemistry, Calc AB, Statistics	Med school prereqs often waived
Business / Economics	Macroeconomics, Statistics, Calc AB	Covers intro-level business courses
Computer Science	CS A, CS Principles, Calc BC, Statistics	Direct CS credit at most schools
Social Sciences	US History, Psychology, Govt & Politics	Fulfills gen-ed requirements
Humanities / English	English Lang, English Lit, World History	Writing and humanities credits
Environmental Science	Environmental Sci, Biology, Statistics	Niche but accepted at many schools
Architecture / Design	Calc AB, Physics 1, Art History	Foundation requirements

■ Credit Transfer at Top 10 US Universities

Score required to earn credit (typically 3, 4, or 5 on AP exam):

University	Calc BC	CS A	Chemistry	Biology	Statistics	English Lang
MIT	5	5	5	5	—	—
Stanford	5	5	5	5	5	5
UC Berkeley	3	3	3	3	3	3
University of Michigan	4	4	4	4	4	4
UCLA	3	3	3	3	3	3
Purdue	4	4	4	4	3	3
UT Austin	3	3	3	3	3	3
Penn State	4	4	3	3	3	3
ASU	3	3	3	3	3	3
Northeastern	4	4	4	4	4	4

■ AP Exam Difficulty & Pass Rate

AP Exam	Difficulty (1-5)	% Scoring 3+	Credits (avg)	PathWays Tip
Calculus BC	4/5	60%	4	Take Calc AB first if needed
CS A (Java)	3/5	67%	3	Practice coding daily — not just theory
Chemistry	4/5	55%	4	Lab knowledge is heavily tested
Biology	4/5	64%	4	Focus on FRQ essay answers
Physics C	5/5	67%	4	Strongest STEM credit — worth the effort
Statistics	3/5	60%	3	Most accessible for non-STEM students
English Lang	3/5	60%	3	Master rhetorical analysis essay
Macroeconomics	2/5	58%	3	Good entry-level AP for most students